Nathalie El-Bazzal

PhD Candidate in Economics, University of Paris 8
Research Affiliate, Paris School of Economics

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Research Interests

International Trade · Geoeconomics · Political Economy · Global Value Chains

Education

2026-Present	**PhD in Economics**, University of Paris 8, France Thesis: "Trade Shocks and Geoeconomic Fragmentation" Supervisor: Prof. Jamel Saadaoui
2024-2026	**Pre-Doctoral Studies in Economics**, University Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne, France Highest Honors (GPA: 4.0/4.0) Coursework: Econometrics; International Trade; Applied Quantitative Methods; Firm Competitiveness; Trade and Finance
2020-2021	**MSc in Financial Management**, ESCP Business School, France Thesis: "Foreign Direct Investment in a Conflict Country: The Syrian Case"
2018-2020	**MA in International Relations**, Sciences Po Grenoble, France Middle Eastern and Mediterranean Studies Thesis: "Economic Recovery in Syria under Political Instability"
2014-2018	**BA in Political Science**, University of Lille, France Third year at Saint Joseph University of Beirut, Lebanon (2017-2018)

Research

Working Paper

Chokepoint Risk and Trade: Evidence from the Red Sea Crisis
Single-authored · Best Graduate Student Paper Award, SETC-FREIT 2026

Work in Progress

Geoeconomic Fragmentation and Market Integration during the Syrian Conflict
with Pierre-Louis Vézina (King's College London) · Accepted at the ReCIPE Annual Conference 2027, Oxford

Measuring Bilateral Geopolitical Tensions
with Jean-Charles Bricongne (Banque de France), Benoît Chaulvet (Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne), Thomas Renault (Paris-Saclay), and Jamel Saadaoui (Paris 8)

Research Notes

When Market Spillovers Are Not Geopolitics (2026)
with Jamel Saadaoui (Paris 8)

Grants and Awards

2026-2028	**CEPR ReCIPE Big Research Grant** (£100,000) "Trade and Financial Frictions in Fragmented Economies" Co-Principal Investigator with Pierre-Louis Vézina (King's College London) and Jean-Charles Bricongne (Banque de France). I initiated, conceptualized, and led the proposal.
2026	**Best Graduate Student Paper Award**, SETC-FREIT Sardinian Empirical Trade Conference, for "Chokepoint Risk and Trade: Evidence from the Red Sea Crisis"

Presentations

2027	ReCIPE Annual Conference, Oxford (scheduled, March)
2026	Geopolitical Alignment, Tensions, and the Global Economy, Paris Nanterre (scheduled, December); Kiel-CEPR Conference on Geoeconomics (Junior Poster Session), Berlin; Sardinian Empirical Trade Conference (SETC-FREIT), Alghero; European Trade Study Group (ETSG), Exeter; Economic Data Science Society Inaugural Conference (poster), Banque de France, Paris; World Trade Dialogue, Hamburg

Discussions

2026	"Russia's Wartime Economy: Measuring Regional Inequalities from Outer Space", by J. Fidrmuc, I. Barbakadze, M. Hulényi, and K. Kapanadze Geopolitical Alignment, Tensions, and the Global Economy (scheduled, December)
2026	"Evading Sanctions", by F. A. Teti, L. Scheckenhofer, D. Torun, and J. Wanner Sardinian Empirical Trade Conference (SETC-FREIT)
2026	"Geopolitical Risk and Foreign Dependence in Global Shipping", by S. Fuchs, F. Leibovici, and W. F. Wong World Trade Dialogue

Workshops

2027	ReCIPE-PEDL Workshop (CEPR), Oxford (scheduled, March)

Teaching

University Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne

Fall 2026	**Introduction to Geopolitics**, Module Leader (Collège de Management, third-year undergraduate) Designed the full module: syllabus, curriculum, lectures, and teaching materials.
Spring 2026	**Introduction to Econometrics**, Teaching Assistant (Economics, undergraduate)
Fall 2025	**History of Economic Thought**, Teaching Assistant (Economics, undergraduate)

IRIS Sup' - Institute for International and Strategic Affairs

2023-Present **Master's Thesis Supervisor and Project Leader**

- Supervise Master's theses in geopolitics, international trade, and development.
- Supervise group reports on public-private partnerships, economic diversification, labor markets, and geopolitical disruptions.

Research Experience

2026-Present **Junior Researcher**, Paris School of Economics

- Research on international trade, geoeconomics, and geopolitical fragmentation.
- Scientific coordination and day-to-day management of the CEPR ReCIPE project.

Professional Experience

2022-2024 **Trade Advisor, Industry and Cleantech**, Business France, French Embassy, Cairo, Egypt

- Sectoral economic analyses across energy, infrastructure, transport, water, defense, and security.
- Advised more than 160 firms on market-entry strategies and international expansion across MENA.
- Organized high-level trade missions across Egypt, Jordan, Tunisia, and the UAE.

Nov 2021-Jan 2022	**Digital Transformation Analyst**, Safran, Paris, France • Quantitative analysis of digital-transformation strategies and organizational performance. • Synthesized academic literature to support strategic decision-making.
Sep 2021-Feb 2022	**Research Assistant and Project Coordinator**, ESCP Business School, Paris, France • Coordinated research projects within the Corporate Governance and Retailing Chairs. • Applied research on foreign-direct-investment screening and retail transformation.
2019-2020	**Chief Education Advisor**, French High School Charles de Gaulle, Damascus, Syria • Managed academic operations and implemented educational policies in a complex geopolitical environment.
Sep 2018-Mar 2019	**Trade Officer**, Business France, French Embassy, Doha, Qatar • Economic and sectoral analyses of Qatari industries. • Organized the Qatar-France Business and Investment Forum.

Invited Talks and Outreach

Sep 2026	Invited Panelist, "Peace Agreements in the Middle East: What Future(s) for the Region?" La Fabrique de la Diplomatie, French Ministry for Europe and Foreign Affairs, Paris
May 2026	Guest Lecturer, "How Do Middle East Conflicts Affect Maritime Corridors and International Trade?" HEIP, Master's in International Relations and Cooperation (Economic Diplomacy), Paris

Other Activities

2023-Present	**Delegate**, ESCP Alumni MENA
2016-2020	**Founder**, Public Speaking Club (workshops in France, Lebanon, and Qatar)
Jul-Aug 2018	**Journalism Intern**, Aujourd'hui la Turquie, Istanbul, Turkey
2014-2015	**Former High-Level Athlete, Wrestling** Silver medal, French National Championships (2015); bronze medal (2014); international medalist.

Skills

Software	R, Python, Stata, LaTeX
Languages	French and Arabic (native), English (fluent)